

RHYTHM CODE OS WORKBOOK

Your hands-on companion to "The Rhythm Code" by Tamas Bodzsar
Transcribe · Analyze · Build · Compose

SECTION 1

Binary Transcription Templates

Transcribe a song here. Mark ● where notes start. Leave · for empty positions. Use these grids to build your binary reading fluency.

Song: _____ Artist: _____ Instrument: _____

Measure 1

1 + 2 + 3 + 4 +

Measure 2

1 + 2 + 3 + 4 +

NOTES:

Song: _____ Artist: _____ Instrument: _____

Measure 1

1 + 2 + 3 + 4 +

Measure 2

1 + 2 + 3 + 4 +

SECTION 2

Stop Detection Worksheet

Transcribe the melody, then circle the STOPS — the last note before silence in each phrase. Count where they fall.

Song: _____

Measure 1 — circle all stops

1 + 2 + 3 + 4 +

Measure 2 — circle all stops

1 + 2 + 3 + 4 +

STOP COUNT	
CATEGORY	COUNT
Stops on STRONG positions	-----
Stops on MEDIUM positions	-----
Stops on AVOID positions	-----
Total stops found	-----

WHAT PATTERNS DO YOU SEE?

SECTION 3

Clave Identification Worksheet

Transcribe the melody's stops, then compare against the clave pattern. Which orientation fits best?

Song: _____

My Transcription (mark stops with ●)

M1

1 + 2 + 3 + 4 +

M2

1 + 2 + 3 + 4 +

Artist: _____

The Clave (2-3 or 3-2? — fill in)

M1

1 + 2 + 3 + 4 +

Does my stop pattern match? Circle one:

2 - 3 **3 - 2** **?**

EVIDENCE:

SECTION 4

Rhythm Code Map Overlay

Use the pre-printed map below. Write your melody stops in the blank cells. Evaluate each stop against the map.

The Rhythm Code Map (2-3 orientation)

1 + 2 + 3 + 4 +

1 + 2 + 3 + 4 +

WHICH STOPS IN MY MELODY ARE ON AVOID POSITIONS?

WHICH STOPS ARE ON STRONG POSITIONS?

4-Step Groove Development

STEP 0: MY BORING VERSION (ALL DOWNBEATS)

STEP 1: AFTER — QUARTER NOTE ANTICIPATION ADDED

STEP 2: AFTER — 3-SIDE FIRST BEAT ANTICIPATED

STEP 3: AFTER — AVOID STOPS REMOVED / MOVED TO UPBEATS

STEP 4: GROOVE COMPLETE — BEAT 3 OF 3-SIDE ANTICIPATED

Composition — My Rhythm Code Song

Song Title:

Key:

Clave:

2-3 / 3-2

Tempo:

KICK

Kick Drum Pattern

M1:1+2+3+4+M2:1+2+3+4+

BASS

Bass Line

M1:1+2+3+4+M2:1+2+3+4+

GUITAR / KEYS

Chord Stab / Melody

M1:1+2+3+4+M2:1+2+3+4+

VOCAL

Vocal Melody

M1:1+2+3+4+M2:1+2+3+4+

Progress Checkpoints

Day 15

Can you label upbeats vs. downbeats in any song in real time — just by listening?

☐

Date completed: _____

Day 30

Can you find stops and anticipations in a song without notation — by ear alone?

☐

Date completed: _____

Day 45

Can you clap the clave while listening to 5 different songs across 5 different genres?

☐

Date completed: _____

Day 60

Have you composed a groove using the 4-step Rhythm Code method and recorded it?

☐

Date completed: _____